CHRISTIAN FANE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Science graduate with Distinction-level academic results and hands-on experience developing, training, optimising and integrating machine learning solutions. Founding team member at Searten, contributing across Python-based ML development, AWS cloud infrastructure and full-stack engineering. Experienced in computer vision, model optimisation, real-time inference and cloud-based application development. Combines strong software engineering fundamentals with systems-level problem-solving and the ability to translate complex technical requirements into reliable, practical solutions.

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Cloud Architecture & AWS Infrastructure**
- **Software & Systems Design**
- **AI/ML Engineering & Model Deployment**
- **Technical Problem-Solving & Systems Integration**
- **Stakeholder Communication & Collaboration**
- **Initiative, Adaptability & Continuous Learning**

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Founding Team Member | Searten | *Searten.com* ***July 2023 - August 2025***

- Designed and deployed a hybrid scientific search platform combining semantic AI models with keyword-based retrieval, improving how researchers discover scientific instruments, techniques, and literature.
- Built and trained custom PyTorch models, developed Python/SQL backend services alongside a React frontend, and deployed supporting infrastructure using AWS SageMaker, EC2, S3, and RDS.
- Demonstrated the platform's potential by integrating stakeholder datasets comprising 350 instruments and 41 articles across 22 techniques, resulting in two organisations committing to platform trials.

Research Thesis | Real-Time Diminished Reality | *arXiv:2509.10466* ***July 2024 - June 2025***

- Modified and optimised PyTorch-based computer-vision models for real-time object removal, developing a curriculum-based training regime and curating diverse training datasets. Achieved over 20 FPS at 720p, reducing inference time by 84% against the original model.
- Trained models on cloud GPU infrastructure and integrated them into a Meta Quest 3 mixed-reality system, linking on-device object detection and user selection with server-side GPU-accelerated video inpainting and privacy-preserving point cloud generation.

Infrastructure Automation Project | Ansible & Linux ***February 2026***

- Developed an Ansible playbook to automate Linux server provisioning, configuration management, and repeatable service deployment.
- Automated system configuration, access controls, networking services, persistent storage, and containerised applications using Ansible modules, variables, loops, and task-level verification.
- Deployed and configured self-hosted services using Docker Compose, systemd, Samba, and Caddy, integrating Cloudflare DNS and automated HTTPS.

Personal Project | Real-Time Hike Tracker ***December 2022***

- Built a live tracking website for a two-month New Zealand hiking expedition using React, Firebase, and the Google Maps API.
- Developed scheduled Firebase functions to process daily KML beacon data into Firestore, enabling map-based location visualisation and photo uploads.

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, C, C++, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C#, HTML, CSS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (SageMaker, EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, Networking), Linux, Git, Jenkins, Ansible

Frameworks & Platforms: PyTorch, TensorFlow, React, Next.js, Firebase, Docker

Development Practices: Agile development, Scrum, sprint-based collaboration

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Advanced Computing | University of Sydney ***2025***
Computer Science major, Music minor

- Dalyell Scholar; graduated with Distinction (WAM: 81.2).

Higher School Certificate | Sydney Grammar School ***2019***

- ATAR: 98.3; HSC Honour Roll.
- Prefect and Vice-Captain of Music.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE & LEADERSHIP

Desk Staff | 9 Degrees Waterloo ***Feb 2024 - Present***

- Deliver customer service and operational support in a high-volume climbing gym, combining front-desk operations, safety inductions, barista duties, and facility maintenance.
- Communicate safety requirements clearly, respond to customer needs, and maintain a welcoming environment for a diverse climbing community.
- Developed a browser extension to customise an existing browser-based point-of-sale system, streamlining checkout workflows and reducing overcharging errors

Sound & Lighting Manager | Intrepid Travelling Troupe ***2017, 2018, 2023, 2025***

- Operated production sound and lighting systems for charity theatre productions, coordinating technical cues and troubleshooting issues under live performance conditions.
- Collaborated with performers and production teams to ensure reliable technical execution and smooth show delivery.

Team Member | Climb Fit ***Feb 2022 - Feb 2024***

Sport Coach & Attendant | Sydney Grammar School ***2020 - 2025***

General Executive | Sydney University Ultimate Frisbee Association ***2020 - 2022***